

The Harbour Garden Proposal

Can a bare corner become a useful lunchtime choice?

Fiction boundary: Harbourview, its students and every event in this feature are invented. This is a model of persuasive structure, not evidence for a real proposal.

A corner with a next step

At Harbourview School, the paved corner beside the library is usually empty at lunch. It is too small for a game and too bright for most students to sit there for long. When the student garden team looked at the space, they imagined something modest: two donated planters, shade from a sail and a table where students could sketch, read or wait for a friend.

Thesis: Harbourview School should run a six-week Harbour Garden trial beside the library, then decide whether the space is useful and manageable.

The proposal is not asking every student to garden. It would create one more choice at lunch. A student who wants a quiet conversation, a book or a small job could use the corner; students who prefer sport could still use the oval and courts.

Some people may worry that a garden would cost too much or become untidy. That is a fair concern. A space that cannot be safely and fairly managed would not help students.

Measured response: The trial could begin with donated planters, a simple sign-out tub and a weekly duty-teacher check. The team could record what is used, what needs repair and whether the corner works before asking for a longer commitment.

Ending with a future readers can picture

A persuasive ending does not pretend one small project will solve every lunchtime problem. Instead, it returns to the main position, makes a worthwhile future visible and asks an audience for one specific action.

Model conclusion: Harbourview should approve a six-week Harbour Garden trial near the library. With a small, carefully managed space, the corner **could become** a place where students can read, draw or talk quietly at lunch. The principal can begin by approving the trial and asking the garden team to record what works before a longer decision is made.

Notice the word **could**. It shows a possible future, not a guarantee. The call to action is also limited: approve a trial and collect information. This is more persuasive than promising that a garden will fix every problem.

Trace the three jobs

RETURN What is the writer's position?	FUTURE What change can readers picture?
ACTION Who acts, and what is the first step?	BOUNDARY Which sentence avoids an over-promise?

Reading check

1. Restate the proposal in your own words. 2. Underline a sentence that names a fair concern. 3. Circle the conditional word in the conclusion. 4. Explain why the call to action is realistic. 5. Replace this overclaim: "The Harbour Garden will make everyone happy."

Source note: Writers need their own identified, checked sources for any claim in their assessment. This fictional feature supplies a conclusion pattern only.